



AI-Powered Coaching for Business Managers

How to Coach, Develop, and Support Teams with AI

- ④ Managers will learn how to use AI to prepare, practice, improve, and follow up on coaching conversations — while keeping leadership human.

Why This Course Matters

Managers are expected to do more than ever — and AI can help them prepare better and coach more consistently.



Improve Performance

Drive results through targeted coaching conversations



Give Useful Feedback

Deliver clear, actionable, and timely feedback



Support Development

Build meaningful growth plans for every team member



Handle Difficult Conversations

Navigate tough moments with confidence and clarity



Build Trust

Strengthen relationships through consistent engagement



Follow Up Consistently

Close the loop and hold commitments accountable

What AI-Powered Coaching Means

AI-powered coaching means using AI as a versatile partner across every stage of the coaching process — not as a replacement for the manager.

AI Supports the Manager

AI is a tool in your hands. It amplifies your effectiveness, sharpens your preparation, and helps you show up as a better coach — but the human relationship remains yours to lead.

- **Preparation Partner**
Think through the conversation before it happens
- **Question Generator**
Surface powerful coaching questions you might miss
- **Feedback Writing Assistant**
Draft clear, structured feedback with the right tone
- **Role-Play Partner**
Practice difficult conversations in a safe space
- **Reflection Partner**
Process what happened and what to do next
- **Follow-Up Planner**
Create structured next steps and accountability notes

What AI Should Not Do

⊗ Manager judgment comes first. AI is a draft tool — never a decision-maker.

No Employment Decisions

AI must never determine hiring, firing, or promotions. These decisions require human judgment, context, and accountability.

No Replacement for Empathy

Emotional intelligence, compassion, and genuine human connection cannot be automated or delegated to a machine.

No Discipline or Ratings

Performance ratings and disciplinary actions carry legal and ethical weight that only a manager can own.

No Confidential HR Issues Alone

Sensitive employee matters must never be handled solely through AI tools — privacy and trust are paramount.

No Robotic Scripts

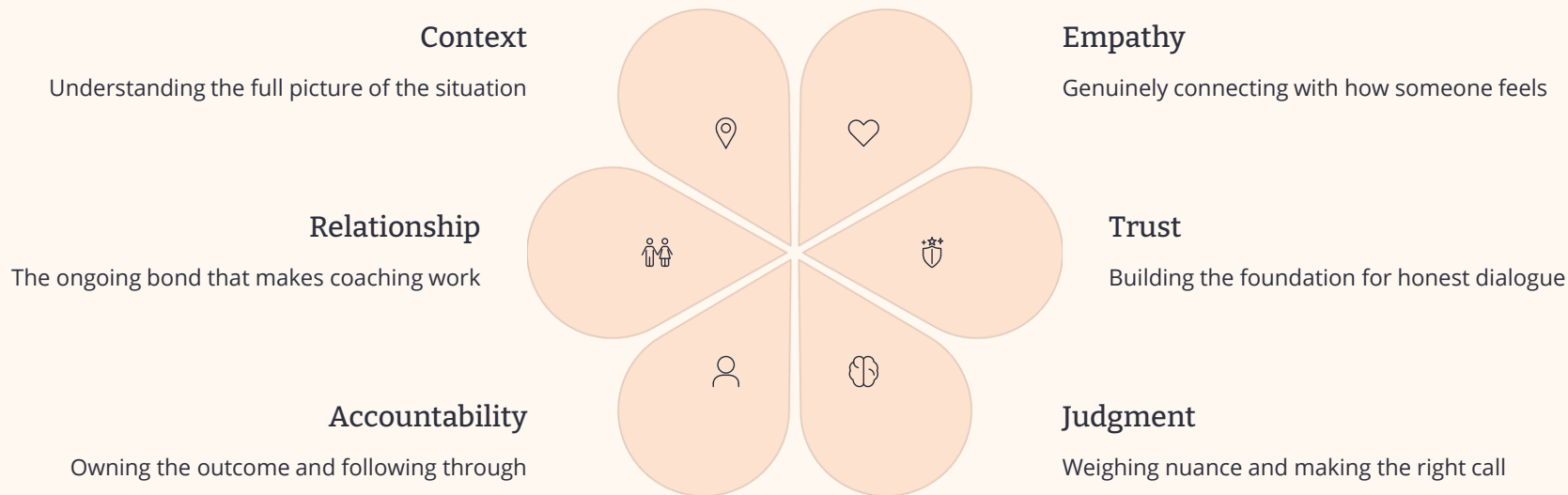
AI output should be a starting point, not a word-for-word script. Authentic conversations require a human voice.

No Removal of Accountability

The manager remains fully responsible for every coaching outcome, regardless of how AI was used to prepare.

The Human Manager Still Owns the Moment

AI can help you prepare — but what happens in the room is entirely yours. The coaching conversation is a human moment that no tool can replicate.



Coaching is still a human conversation. AI prepares the manager — the manager shows up for the person.

The Manager Coaching Challenge

Most managers know coaching matters. But knowing and doing are two different things. Real barriers get in the way every day.

Limited Time

Coaching gets deprioritized when calendars are packed and urgent tasks dominate the day.

Unclear Wording

Managers struggle to find the right words, especially for sensitive or complex feedback.

Avoiding Hard Conversations

Discomfort with conflict leads to delayed or diluted conversations that don't create change.

Weak Follow-Up

Without structured notes and reminders, commitments made in coaching sessions fade quickly.

Vague Development Plans

Growth conversations lack specificity, leaving employees unsure of what to actually do next.

Inconsistent One-on-Ones

Regular check-ins get cancelled or become status updates rather than meaningful coaching moments.

✔ **AI helps reduce friction** — giving managers a faster path from intention to action in every one of these areas.

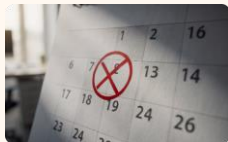
Common Coaching Moments

AI can support managers across the full range of coaching situations — from everyday check-ins to high-stakes conversations.



One-on-Ones

Prepare agendas, questions, and talking points for regular check-ins that actually move the needle.



Missed Deadlines

Address performance gaps with clarity and curiosity rather than frustration or avoidance.



Constructive Feedback

Draft balanced, specific, and actionable feedback that lands well and drives improvement.



Recognition

Craft meaningful recognition that reinforces the right behaviors and motivates continued excellence.

Goal Setting

Build SMART goals with clear milestones and accountability checkpoints.

Development Planning

Create individualized growth plans tied to real career aspirations.

Career Conversations

Explore long-term paths and opportunities with structure and intention.

Difficult Conversations

Prepare for high-stakes moments with role-play and scenario planning.

Follow-Up Notes

Capture commitments and next steps in clear, professional language.

Responsible AI Use for Managers

Using AI responsibly is not optional — it is a professional obligation. Before entering any information into an AI tool, follow these essential guidelines.

1

Remove Names & Private Details

Never enter identifying information about employees into any AI tool. Anonymize all scenarios before prompting.

2

No Sensitive HR Information

Keep confidential HR matters — investigations, medical issues, legal concerns — completely out of AI systems.

3

Review for Bias

AI can reflect and amplify bias. Always critically review output for fairness, tone, and unintended assumptions.

4

Check Accuracy

AI can generate plausible-sounding but incorrect content. Verify facts, context, and recommendations before using.

5

Rewrite in Your Own Voice

AI output should be a starting draft. Personalize it so the conversation sounds like you, not a machine.

6

Follow Company Policy

Always comply with your organization's guidelines on AI tool usage, data privacy, and acceptable use.



AI output is a draft, not a decision. Every word that comes out of a coaching conversation is your responsibility as a manager.

AI Practice — Coaching Use Case Map

Choose one real coaching situation from your current work. Use the framework below to structure your thinking — then apply the AI prompt to begin your preparation.

Your Reflection Questions

01

What conversation do I need to have?

Name the situation clearly and specifically.

02

What feels difficult?

Identify the friction — emotional, relational, or practical.

03

What outcome do I want?

Define success for both you and the employee.

04

How could AI help me prepare?

Choose the role AI will play: questions, draft, role-play, or plan.

Your AI Prompt

Copy and use this prompt to begin your coaching preparation:

"Act as a leadership coaching partner. Help me prepare for this coaching situation: [describe situation without private details]. Identify the purpose, risks, useful questions, and possible next steps."

- ❑ Remove all names and private details before entering your situation into any AI tool. The output is a starting point — rewrite it in your own voice before the conversation.



This cycle can be repeated for every coaching moment — building your skills and confidence over time with AI as your preparation partner.

Coaching Fundamentals Every Manager Needs

Strong coaching is built on a core set of skills that empower people to grow, solve problems, and take ownership. AI works best when managers already understand these basics.



Listening



Questioning



Feedback



Goal Setting



Accountability



Development Planning



Follow-Up



Coaching vs. Directing

Directing Says:

"Here is what to do."

Directing is appropriate when speed, safety, or compliance is the priority. It provides clear instruction and immediate guidance.

Coaching Asks:

"What is happening, what options do you see, and what action will you take?"

Coaching is the right approach when **growth, ownership, or problem-solving** matters. It builds capability over time.

- 📌 Managers need both — the skill is knowing when to use each.

The P.R.E.P.A.R.E. Coaching Model

Use this structure to guide most coaching conversations from start to finish. Each step builds on the last to create a complete, productive dialogue.

1

Purpose

Set the intention and context for the conversation.

2

Reality

Explore the current situation honestly and openly.

3

Explore

Identify options, possibilities, and perspectives.

4

Plan

Agree on specific actions and next steps.

5

Accountability

Define who owns what and by when.

6

Reinforce

Acknowledge progress and build confidence.

7

Evaluate

Review outcomes and adjust the approach as needed.

Listening Before Solving

Great coaches resist the urge to jump to solutions. Before giving advice, a manager must truly hear what the employee is communicating — on multiple levels.



Manager Action: Before giving advice, ask at least **two open-ended questions** to fully understand the situation.

Listen For:

Facts

What actually happened or is happening?

Emotions

How is the person feeling about it?

Barriers

What is getting in the way?

Patterns

Is this a recurring theme?

Assumptions

What beliefs are shaping their view?

Support Needs

What kind of help would make a difference?

Better Coaching Questions

Strong questions create ownership. The right question shifts responsibility back to the employee and opens up new thinking.

- What is getting in the way?
- What have you already tried?
- What options do you see?
- What support would help?
- What is one next step you can commit to?

📄 **AI Prompt:** "Generate 10 open-ended coaching questions for this situation: [insert situation]. Make them practical, respectful, and ownership-focused."

Feedback That Helps

Useful feedback is not about criticism — it is about clarity. When feedback is specific, timely, and connected to expectations, it becomes a tool for growth rather than a source of anxiety.

 **Avoid vague feedback like:** "You need to communicate better." — It gives no direction and creates confusion.

Useful Feedback Is:

Specific

Behavior-Based

Timely

Clear on Impact

Tied to Expectations

Supportive but Direct

Feedback Formula

Use this six-step structure to deliver feedback that is clear, fair, and actionable every time.

1 Observation

Describe what you saw or heard — stick to facts, not interpretations.

2 Impact

Explain the effect on the team, project, or organization.

3 Expectation

State clearly what the standard or requirement is going forward.

4 Employee Perspective

Invite the employee to share their view — listen before responding.

5 Next Step

Agree on a specific, concrete action to move forward.

6 Follow-Up

Set a time to check in and acknowledge progress.

Example: "When updates are late, the team cannot plan accurately. Going forward, I need status updates by **Friday at noon.**"

Goal Setting and Accountability

A coaching goal without structure is just a wish. Every strong development goal needs the right components to ensure follow-through and measurable progress.



AI Prompt: "Help me turn this development need into 3 practical SMART goals: [insert need]. Include success measures and a 30-day follow-up plan."

A Strong Coaching Goal Includes:

01

Clear Outcome

What does success look like?

02

Action Steps

What specific behaviors will drive progress?

03

Owner

Who is responsible for each step?

04

Timeline

By when will each step be completed?

05

Support Needed

What resources or help are required?

06

Progress Measure & Follow-Up Date

How will progress be tracked and reviewed?

Practice — Upgrade the Conversation

Rewrite these common manager statements into genuine coaching questions. The goal is to shift from telling to asking — and from judgment to curiosity.

Original Statement

"You need to be more proactive."

"Stop missing deadlines."

"You need to communicate better."

"You should take more ownership."

Coaching Question Approach

What opportunities have you noticed that you haven't acted on yet?

What is getting in the way of hitting your deadlines consistently?

How do you think your teammates are experiencing your updates right now?

What would it look like if you fully owned this from start to finish?

 **AI Practice:** Ask AI to suggest better questions for each statement, then choose the most human-sounding ones. Your judgment matters — AI generates options, you make the call.

Workflow 1 — Prepare for a One-on-One

Use AI *before* the meeting to sharpen your thinking, structure your approach, and show up as a more effective coach. AI is a preparation tool — not a script.



Clarify Purpose

Define what you want to achieve in the conversation



Build an Agenda

Structure the meeting so time is used well



Generate Questions

Craft thoughtful coaching questions in advance



Identify Sensitive Areas

Anticipate topics that need careful handling



Plan Follow-Up

Commit to next steps before the meeting ends

 Use AI as preparation — not as a script. Your voice, judgment, and relationship with the employee are irreplaceable.

Copy-and-Paste Prompt — One-on-One Prep

Use the prompt below to generate a structured preparation plan before your next one-on-one. Fill in each bracketed field with specifics about your employee and situation.

The AI Prompt

"Act as an executive leadership coach helping a busy manager prepare for an employee one-on-one.

Context:

Employee role: [insert]

Main topics: [insert]

Recent wins: [insert]

Current concerns: [insert]

Manager goal: [insert]"

What AI Will Create

01

A Simple Agenda

Structured flow for the meeting

02

5 Coaching Questions

Open-ended questions to draw out insight

03

2 Recognition Points

Specific, sincere acknowledgment of wins

04

Sensitive Areas

Topics to handle with care and intention

05

Follow-Up Actions

Commitments to close the loop after the meeting

Scenario — Employee Missing Deadlines

THE SITUATION

Jordan's Pattern

Jordan has missed **three deadlines in six weeks**. Work quality remains good, but the delays are creating downstream impact on the rest of the team.

⚠️ The pattern matters — even when the work itself is strong, repeated delays affect team trust and delivery.

MANAGER CHALLENGE

Address Without Assuming

The risk is jumping to conclusions about motivation or attitude. The manager must address the **observable pattern** without assuming laziness or disengagement.

🧠 AI USE

Use AI to **separate facts from assumptions** and prepare a fair, evidence-based coaching plan that opens dialogue rather than closes it.



Prompt — Underperformance Coaching

This prompt helps you prepare a structured, fair coaching conversation when an employee is missing deadlines or falling short of expectations.

The AI Prompt

"Act as a manager coaching advisor. Help me prepare for a coaching conversation with an employee who is missing deadlines.

Facts: [insert observable facts]

Expected standard: [insert]

Impact: [insert]"

AI Will Provide

- **Opening Statement**
A calm, factual way to begin the conversation
- **Perspective Questions**
Questions to understand the employee's point of view
- **Feedback Statement**
Clear, specific, and non-judgmental feedback
- **Action Plan + Follow-Up**
Concrete next steps and accountability commitments
- **Phrases to Avoid**
Language that escalates or shuts down dialogue

Scenario — High Performer Disengaged

THE SITUATION

Avery's Crossroads

Avery is a **strong performer** — results are solid, skills are sharp. But something has shifted. Avery seems less engaged and recently said:

"I'm not sure where I'm going here."

This is a signal, not a complaint. Avery is looking for direction, meaning, and a sense of future within the organization.

MANAGER CHALLENGE

Re-Engage Without Overpromising

The temptation is to reassure Avery with promises about promotions or future roles. The challenge is to **re-engage authentically** — exploring what matters to Avery without committing to outcomes you cannot guarantee.

- ① **AI Use:** Prepare a career, motivation, and development conversation that opens possibilities without creating false expectations.



Prompt — Recognition

Specific, sincere recognition is one of the most powerful tools a manager has. Use this prompt to craft recognition that lands — not generic praise, but acknowledgment tied to real behavior and real impact.

The AI Prompt

"Act as a leadership coach. Help me write specific recognition for an employee."

Employee action: [insert]

Impact: [insert]

Strength shown: [insert]

Draft:

1. A short verbal message
2. A written message
3. A message connecting the behavior to team or business goals.

Keep it sincere and specific."

Why Specificity Matters

Verbal Message

Delivered in the moment or in a one-on-one — brief, warm, and direct

Written Message

An email or note the employee can keep and reference later

Business Connection

Links the individual's behavior to something larger — team goals, culture, or results



Recognition that names the specific action and its impact is far more motivating than "great job."

Prompt — Development Planning

Turn career conversations into concrete action. This prompt generates a structured 60-day development plan tailored to the employee's role, interests, and available opportunities.

The AI Prompt

"Act as an employee development coach. Create a 60-day development plan.

Employee role: [insert]

Career interest: [insert]

Current strengths: [insert]

Skills to develop: [insert]

Available opportunities: [insert]"

Plan Components

Goal

Clear development objective

Weekly Actions

Specific steps each week

Practice Opportunities

Real-world application moments

Manager Support

How you will coach and enable

Evidence of Progress

How growth will be visible

Check-In Questions

Prompts for ongoing dialogue

Obstacles

Anticipated barriers and how to address them

Scenario — Resisting Change

THE SITUATION

Sam's Skepticism

Sam is openly skeptical about a new process being rolled out. The concern isn't just personal — Sam is **influencing others to resist**, creating friction across the team before the change has even been fully implemented.

⚠️ Resistance that spreads can undermine team cohesion and slow adoption — even when the underlying concerns are valid.

MANAGER CHALLENGE

Empathy + Accountability

Sam may have **valid concerns** worth hearing. The manager's challenge is to genuinely listen and acknowledge what's real — while also being clear that the expectation is to move forward constructively.

☆ AI USE

Use AI to **role-play the conversation** and practice holding both empathy and accountability at the same time — without collapsing into one or the other.

Scenario — New Manager Coaching a Former Peer

THE SITUATION

Taylor & Morgan

Taylor has recently been promoted and now manages **former peer Morgan**. The dynamic has shifted — but Morgan hasn't fully adjusted. Commitments are being missed, and Morgan has said:

"You know how things work around here."

This is a test of the new authority — and of the relationship.

MANAGER CHALLENGE

Reset Without Breaking Trust

Taylor needs to **reset expectations clearly** — making it understood that the relationship has changed and accountability is real — without damaging the trust and rapport built as peers.

 AI Use: Draft a respectful, direct opening statement and use AI to practice the conversation before having it live.

The goal is a conversation that honors the history while establishing the new dynamic with clarity and care.

Scenario — Career Growth Without a Plan

THE SITUATION

Riley's Ambition

Riley is motivated and wants to grow. But the ambition is unfocused. Riley has said:

"I want to move up, but I don't know what to focus on."

The desire is real. The direction is missing. This is an opportunity — not a problem.

MANAGER CHALLENGE

Turn Ambition Into Action

The manager's role is to help Riley **translate vague aspiration into a practical, achievable plan** — one that builds momentum and creates visible progress within 60 days.

AI USE

Career Questions

Prompts to surface what Riley truly values

Goal Options

Possible directions based on role and interests

60-Day Plan

Concrete weekly actions to build toward the goal



Activity — Build One AI-Supported Coaching Plan

Choose one scenario from this module. Use AI to draft your plan — then revise the output in your own voice before using it.

Choose Your Scenario

- Jordan — Missing Deadlines
- Avery — High Performer Disengaged
- Sam — Resisting Change
- Taylor — New Manager, Former Peer
- Riley — Career Growth Without a Plan



Use AI to generate the first draft. Then make it yours.

Your Coaching Plan Must Include

01

Conversation Purpose

What outcome are you working toward?

02

Opening Statement

How will you begin — calmly and clearly?

03

5 Coaching Questions

Open-ended questions that invite reflection

04

Feedback or Recognition Message

Specific, sincere, and tied to observable behavior

05

Next Steps + Follow-Up Date

Concrete commitments with a clear timeline

Practicing Difficult Conversations with AI

AI role-play gives managers a safe, private space to rehearse before the real moment arrives — building confidence, refining language, and preparing for resistance.



Practice First

Rehearse before real conversations



Test Wording

Refine how you say it



Prepare for Pushback

Anticipate resistance



Build Confidence

Improve with every attempt



Receive Feedback

Get coaching after each session



Try Again Safely

No real stakes, real learning



Practice makes the real conversation better. Every rehearsal reduces anxiety and sharpens your approach.

Role-Play Prompt — Defensive Employee

Use this prompt to simulate a challenging conversation with an employee who missed deadlines and responds with emotional pushback. The AI will hold its ground — and then coach you.

AI Prompt: "Act as a defensive employee who missed several deadlines. I am your manager. Push back respectfully but emotionally. Do not make the conversation easy. After 6 exchanges, switch to coaching observer and evaluate my performance."

After 6 exchanges, the AI evaluates you across five dimensions:

1

Clarity

Were your expectations clearly communicated?

2

Empathy

Did you acknowledge the employee's perspective?

3

Listening

Did you pause and respond to what was said?

4

Accountability

Did you hold the standard without attacking?

5

Follow-Up

Did you close with clear next steps?

Role-Play Prompt

Hesitant Employee

This scenario trains managers to create psychological safety — drawing out an employee who is afraid to speak honestly.

📄 **Key challenge:** The employee only opens up if you ask the right questions with the right tone.

AI Prompt: "Act as a hesitant employee who is unsure whether it is safe to speak honestly. I am your manager. Be cautious at first. If I ask supportive open-ended questions, gradually share more. After 6 exchanges, give feedback on my tone, listening, and questions."

What the AI evaluates after the session:

→ Tone

Did your language feel safe and non-threatening?

→ Listening

Did you reflect back what the employee shared?

→ Questions

Were your questions open-ended and genuinely curious?



Role-Play Prompt — Disengaged Employee

This scenario challenges managers to stay patient and curious when an employee gives minimal responses and seems emotionally checked out. The real reason only emerges if you ask the right questions.

AI Prompt: "Act as a disengaged employee who gives short answers and seems checked out. I am your manager. Do not reveal the full reason immediately. If I ask thoughtful questions, share more context. After 6 exchanges, evaluate my patience, curiosity, and next steps."

Patience

Did you resist filling silence or rushing to conclusions?

Curiosity

Did you dig deeper rather than accept surface answers?

Next Steps

Did you leave the conversation with a clear path forward?

AI as Coaching Observer

After completing a practice conversation, use AI to step back and evaluate your performance objectively. Paste an anonymized transcript or coaching plan and let the AI act as your personal coaching observer.

AI Prompt: "Act as a coaching observer. Review this anonymized coaching plan or transcript: [insert]. Evaluate the following dimensions, then give me 2 strengths, 2 improvements, and a stronger closing statement."

01

Purpose

Was the goal of the conversation clear?

02

Listening

Did you demonstrate active listening?

03

Questions

Were questions open and coaching-oriented?

04

Feedback Clarity

Was feedback specific and actionable?

05

Empathy

Did you acknowledge feelings and context?

06

Accountability

Were standards upheld with respect?

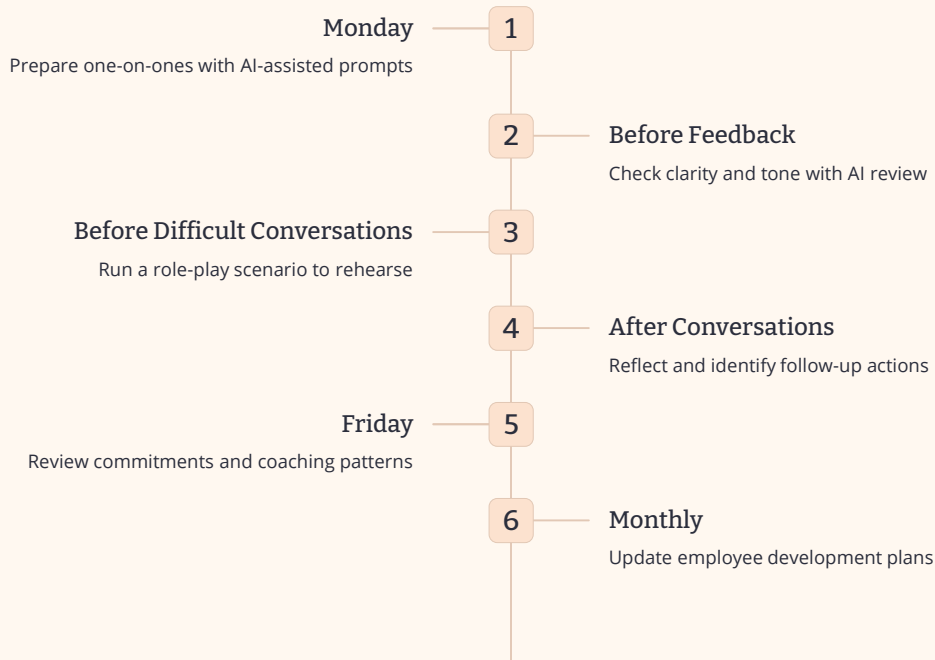
07

Follow-Up

Were next steps defined and owned?

Repeatable Weekly AI Coaching Workflow

Build AI-assisted coaching into your weekly rhythm. This workflow ensures you are always prepared, reflective, and improving — without adding significant time to your schedule.



Consistency is the key. A few minutes of AI-assisted preparation each day compounds into significantly stronger coaching over time.

Post-Conversation Reflection Prompt

Use this prompt after any coaching conversation — real or practice — to extract learning and plan your next move.

📌 Always anonymize before pasting any conversation details into AI tools.

AI Prompt: "Act as a coaching reflection partner. Conversation summary: [anonymized summary]. My goal was: [insert]. What happened: [insert]."

The AI will provide structured reflection across six areas:

- 1 What I Handled Well
- 2 Missed Coaching Opportunities
- 3 Clarity of Next Steps
- 4 Follow-Up Actions
- 5 One Thing to Improve
- 6 A Short Follow-Up Message

Final Project — AI Coaching Teammate Toolkit

Your final project is to build a personalized AI Coaching Teammate Toolkit — a complete, reusable resource that reflects your coaching philosophy and integrates AI at every stage of the coaching cycle.

1

Coaching Philosophy

Your personal statement of purpose as a coach

2

One-on-One Prep Prompt

AI prompt for preparing weekly check-ins

3

Feedback Prompt

AI prompt for drafting clear, empathetic feedback

4

Development Planning Prompt

AI prompt for building employee growth plans

5

Role-Play Prompt

Difficult conversation rehearsal scenario

6

Reflection Prompt

Post-conversation learning and follow-up

7

Weekly Workflow

Your repeatable AI-assisted coaching rhythm

8

Ethical Use Checklist

Guardrails for responsible AI use

9

Success Measures

How you will know your coaching is working

Coaching Philosophy Template

Your coaching philosophy is the foundation of your toolkit. It defines what you believe about your role — and where AI fits within it. Complete the statement below and make it your own.

"My coaching role is to help employees **understand expectations, build confidence, strengthen performance,** and **take ownership of growth.**
I will use AI to **prepare, practice, and reflect** — but I will keep **empathy, judgment, trust, and accountability** as my responsibility."

AI's Role

Prepare · Practice · Reflect · Draft · Analyze

Your Role

Empathy · Judgment · Trust · Accountability · Relationship

- ④ The most effective coaching happens when human wisdom and AI capability work together — each doing what it does best.



Ethical Use Checklist

Before using AI in any coaching context, run through this checklist. Responsible use protects your employees, your organization, and your integrity as a leader.

Privacy Protected

I removed all private employee details before using AI

HR Boundaries Respected

I avoided entering sensitive HR or legal information

Bias Reviewed

I checked the AI output for potential bias or unfair framing

Accuracy Verified

I confirmed the content is factually accurate and appropriate

Humanized

I adapted the wording so it sounds like me, not a machine

Policy Compliant

I followed my organization's AI and data use policies

Final Decision Mine

I made the final judgment call — AI only informed it



Never paste identifiable employee information into any AI tool. Always anonymize first.

Course Success Check

You have completed the course. You are ready to lead with AI as your coaching teammate. Use this checklist to confirm your readiness — and return to it whenever you want to measure your growth.



Prepare Conversations

Use AI to prepare for coaching conversations with clarity and purpose



Recognize Performance

Craft meaningful recognition that motivates and reinforces growth



Reflect After Coaching

Extract learning from every conversation to continuously improve



Ask Stronger Questions

Generate open-ended, coaching-quality questions with AI support



Build Development Plans

Co-create employee growth plans that are realistic and inspiring



Identify Follow-Up Actions

Close every conversation with clear, owned next steps



Draft Clearer Feedback

Use AI to write specific, balanced, and actionable feedback



Practice Difficult Conversations

Rehearse challenging scenarios safely before the real moment



Improve Team Performance

Build a coaching culture that drives sustained team growth over time

✓ **You are ready.** AI does not replace your coaching — it amplifies it. Lead with empathy, prepare with AI, and keep growing.